



Sponsor Prompt Guide:

Company	A Little Bit of Hope
Category	Cybersecurity
Description of Prompt	Targeted Audience: Those with an interest in cybersecurity and data visualization. No prior security experience is required; the challenge is designed to be approachable for beginners while offering depth for advanced teams. Challenge Overview: Participants will build a web-based, real-time dashboard that ingests raw security log data (firewall, authentication, DNS, and malware alerts) and transforms it into a cohesive, actionable visual narrative. The goal is to help a Security Operations Center (SOC) analyst detect and understand a coordinated attack from a single interface — in 30 seconds or less. Resources Provided: Sample log data files in CSV format: auth_logs.csv, dns_logs.csv, firewall_logs.csv, and malware_alerts.csv — simulating two real-world attack scenarios.
Submission Software	Web-based application. The solution must be accessible via a browser. Teams may host locally or deploy to any platform of their choice.
Suggested Languages/Frameworks/Tools	***No requirements/restrictions on tools, examples below: Frontend: HTML/CSS/JavaScript, React, Vue.js, D3.js, Chart.js, Leaflet.js Backend: Python (Flask/FastAPI), Node.js Data handling: Python (pandas, csv), JavaScript (Papa Parse) AI/ML: scikit-learn, TensorFlow, PyTorch, OpenAI API
Midpoint Judging/Check-In	Teams will present a progress check-in demonstrating: (1) successful ingestion of at least one log data source, and (2) an initial visualization

	rendered in the browser. Judges will provide feedback on design direction and technical approach.
Submission Expectations	• A working web-based dashboard ingesting the provided sample log data. • A presentation explaining the design and technical decisions, including a demo of the solution and any AI/ML features implemented
High-Level Judging Rubric	Articulate the Why: Clear explanation of the problems statement, and justification of design and technical decisions. Security Fundamentals: Demonstrated understanding of the provided log data and ability to identify attack patterns (e.g., brute-force login, phishing beacon). Business Impact: Solution framed in terms of measurable outcomes — reduced time to detect, reduced analyst cognitive load, prevention of data exfiltration, etc. Interactivity & Design (UX/UI): Intuitive, simple to use interface with drill-down capability. Correlation Engine: Ability to automatically link related events across multiple log sources. Clarity & Actionability: Dashboard provides information in a way that makes next steps for the analyst are clear.
Category Judges <i>tentative</i>	Kincaid Keating, Amanda White, Floyd Smith, Justin Simpson, Zay Ragland